

ESSENTIAL

Document Checklist by Sponsor Type

Airline - Hotel/Tour Operator - Personal (UAE Resident) - Business

Every applicant needs

- Valid passport, with at least 6 months' remaining validity beyond your entry date
- A recent passport-style digital photo
- Health insurance covering your stay
- Your travel dates and, commonly, a return or onward flight booking

If you're sponsored by an airline

- Your flight booking confirmation with that airline
- Any airline-specific visa fee, paid alongside or separately from your ticket

If you're sponsored by a hotel or tour operator

- Your accommodation or tour booking confirmation
- Any agency service fee on top of the government visa fee

If you're sponsored by a UAE resident or citizen

PERSONAL SPONSORSHIP

A UAE resident or citizen can personally sponsor a family member or friend's tourist visa. This typically requires the sponsor's own Emirates ID and residency documents, and they take on formal responsibility for the application. See the Sponsor Letter Templates (Complete tier) for what a supporting letter from a personal host commonly includes.

If you're travelling for business meetings

- The Tourist Visa covers short, incidental business activities (meetings, negotiations) for many travellers - it does not permit taking up employment or a role in a UAE-based company, which needs a separate work visa/permit sponsored by the employer
- A letter from the company you're meeting, if useful supporting evidence for your sponsor's application

If you've had a previous UAE visa issue

— Be upfront with your sponsor about any previous UAE overstay, deportation, or entry ban - this affects which sponsors and channels can realistically help you, and hiding it doesn't prevent it being found